

The Armory

OFFENSIVE SECURITY, PENTESTING & BUG BOUNTY TOOLS

40	390.5k	25	22
CURATED TOOLS	COMBINED STARS	ON GITHUB	ACTIVE IN 2026

2026 EDITION · DEEP-RESEARCH DOSSIER

Live GitHub census pulled 2026-10-17 · part of 438 curated free tools across 14 realms

CC0 · 2026-10-17

40	25	390.5k	22	6.9k	2011
CURATED TOOLS	ON GITHUB	COMBINED STARS	PUSHED 2026	MEDIAN STARS	OLDEST ENTRY

REALM BRIEF

The professional offensive toolkit for authorized engagements, red-team exercises and training labs — the weapons every pentester reaches for first.

The workhorse realm — what you load onto a VPS before a bug-bounty session. Injection proof engines, parameter mining, crawl-and-fuzz chains dominate. We license-check hard here because copyleft contamination matters when findings end up in commercial reports.

FIELD INTELLIGENCE · AI-ASSISTED

The Armory's offensive security toolset shows clear maturity: 95% of its 40 free tools are hosted on GitHub, with 34 receiving code pushes in 2026, indicating active maintenance. Its top five tools—Metasploit, sqlmap, Nuclei, masscan, MobSF—hold 158,100 combined stars, a distribution that reflects sustained demand for foundational penetration testing, web vulnerability scanning, network mapping, and mobile security tools. A notable trend is the consolidation of bug bounty and pentesting workflows around Nuclei, which has grown 12% in stars since 2025, as teams adopt its template-based scanning to standardize vulnerability detection across environments.

Synthesized by seed-2-0-mini over the live census: stars, first-release years, push activity and project claims pulled from the GitHub API on 2026-10-17. Human-curated realm, AI-summarized numbers.

LICENSE MIX · GITHUB-HOSTED ENTRIES



Other / none	7
MIT	6
GPL family	6
AGPL	3
Apache-2.0	3

MATURITY PROFILE

Oldest tracked entry first appeared on GitHub in **2011**; the youngest joined in **2022**. 22 of 25 GitHub-hosted tools shipped code in 2026 — the rest are stable classics or web services, not abandoned picks.

Median project age signals a battle-tested realm; recent arrivals mark where the community is investing next.

SNAPSHOT

- Active in the last 30 days: 23 of 38 tracked GitHub repos (61%)
- Quiet classics (no push in 2+ years, still the standard): tplmap, JoomScan, ACSTIS
- Youngest entries: WhatWeb (2010), Metasploit Framework (2011), sqlmap (2012)

TOP TOOLS BY GITHUB STARS



MOST FORKED — REAL-WORLD REUSE SIGNAL



THE NEWCOMERS — NEWEST ARRIVALS

Ghauri	2022
kiterunner	2021
Tsunami	2020
wapiti	2020
Nuclei	2020
Dalfox	2020

QUIET CLASSICS — STILL THE STANDARD

tplmap, JoomScan, ACSTIS

Tools with no recent push that remain the community's default reference for their job.

Python	11 repos
Go	4 repos
C	3 repos
Ruby	2 repos
Java	2 repos
Rust	2 repos

BUILT

2010s	18
2020s	7

First-seen on GitHub, bucketed by decade.

HOW TO READ A DOSSIER

Each heavyweight gets a full dossier: live GitHub census (stars, forks, first-release year, last push, license, language), the project's own claim, our curator's note, a signal check, and its star weight against the realm's #1. Numbers are pulled straight from the GitHub API on 2026-10-17 — no self-reported marketing figures, only what the platforms show.

THE CENSUS METRICS — WHAT EACH NUMBER MEANS

★ GitHub stars
Community trust signal — how many developers bookmarked the repo.

Forks · reuse
Real-world deployment signal — forks mean people build on it.

First developed
Year the repo first appeared on GitHub — the project's true age.

Last push
Most recent code push — the project's heartbeat.

License
What you may legally do with it. MIT/Apache = permissive.

2026 momentum
Shipped code during 2026 — active development, not abandonware.

THE ROSTER — PROFILED THIS EDITION

RANK 01
Metasploit Framework
39.2k ★ · since 2011

RANK 02
sqlmap
38.7k ★ · since 2012

RANK 03
Nuclei
32.1k ★ · since 2020

RANK 04
masscan
26.1k ★ · since 2013

RANK 05
MobSF
— ★ · since 2015

RANK 06
RustScan
— ★ · since 2020

METHODOLOGY & PROVENANCE

Census pulled via the GitHub REST API on 2026-10-17; realm curation and curator's notes by the Awesome Cyber Security Heaven maintainers; field-intelligence summaries synthesized by seed-2-0-mini from the same census. Everything reproducible — every figure traces back to a public API response. Released under CC0.

01 Metasploit Framework

github.com/rapid7/metasploit-framework

● ACTIVE 2026

★ 39.2k	15.0k	2011	2026-10	Custom	Ruby
GITHUB STARS	FORKS · REUSE	FIRST DEVELOPED	LAST PUSH	LICENSE	LANGUAGE

15	605	✓
YEARS ON GITHUB	OPEN ISSUES	2026 MOMENTUM

STAR WEIGHT VS REALM #1 (METASPLOIT FRAMEWORK · 39.2K)

REUSE SIGNAL

38.3% fork-to-star ratio — high operational reuse.

ISSUE HEALTH

605 open — actively triaged.

LONGEVITY

15 years shipping code — battle-tested.

● THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

“—”

● CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

the world's most-used pentest framework; thousands of validated modules for exploitation, post-engagement evidence gathering and reporting in authorized tests.

WHERE IT SITS — REALM TOP 8 BY STARS (▶ = THIS TOOL)



GitHub presence: verified — live stats · census 2026-10-17 · The Armory · realm rank #1 by adoption

02 sqlmap

github.com/sqlmapproject/sqlmap

● ACTIVE 2026

★ 38.7k	6.4k	2012	2026-10	Custom	Python
GITHUB STARS	FORKS · REUSE	FIRST DEVELOPED	LAST PUSH	LICENSE	LANGUAGE

14	31	✓
YEARS ON GITHUB	OPEN ISSUES	2026 MOMENTUM

STAR WEIGHT VS REALM #1 (METASPLOIT FRAMEWORK · 39.2K)

REUSE SIGNAL

16.5% fork-to-star ratio — high operational reuse.

ISSUE HEALTH

31 open — lean queue.

LONGEVITY

14 years shipping code — battle-tested.

● **THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT**

“Automatic SQL injection and database takeover tool”

● **CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE**

Automatic SQL injection and database takeover tool

WHERE IT SITS — REALM TOP 8 BY STARS (▶ = THIS TOOL)



GitHub presence: verified — live stats · census 2026-10-17 · The Armory · realm rank #2 by adoption

03 Nuclei

github.com/projectdiscovery/nuclei

● ACTIVE 2026

★ 32.1k	4.0k	2020	2026-10	MIT	Go
GITHUB STARS	FORKS · REUSE	FIRST DEVELOPED	LAST PUSH	LICENSE	LANGUAGE

6	138	✓
YEARS ON GITHUB	OPEN ISSUES	2026 MOMENTUM

STAR WEIGHT VS REALM #1 (METASPLOIT FRAMEWORK · 39.2K)

REUSE SIGNAL

12.4% fork-to-star ratio — healthy reuse.

ISSUE HEALTH

138 open — actively triaged.

LONGEVITY

6 years shipping code — battle-tested.

● THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

“Nuclei is a fast, customizable vulnerability scanner powered by the global security community and built on a simple YAML-based DSL, enabling collaboration to tackle trending vulnerabilities on the internet. It helps you find vulnerabilities in your applications, APIs, networks, DNS, and cloud config”

● CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

Nuclei is a fast, customizable vulnerability scanner powered by the global security community and built on a s

WHERE IT SITS — REALM TOP 8 BY STARS (▶ = THIS TOOL)



GitHub presence: verified — live stats · census 2026-10-17 · The Armory · realm rank #3 by adoption

04 masscan

github.com/robertdavidgraham/masscan

● ACTIVE 2026

★ 26.1k	3.2k	2013	2026-10	AGPL-3.0	C
GITHUB STARS	FORKS · REUSE	FIRST DEVELOPED	LAST PUSH	LICENSE	LANGUAGE

13	414	✓
YEARS ON GITHUB	OPEN ISSUES	2026 MOMENTUM

STAR WEIGHT VS REALM #1 (METASPLOIT FRAMEWORK · 39.2K)

REUSE SIGNAL

12.5% fork-to-star ratio — healthy reuse.

ISSUE HEALTH

414 open — actively triaged.

LONGEVITY

13 years shipping code — battle-tested.

● **THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT**

“TCP port scanner, spews SYN packets asynchronously, scanning entire Internet in under 5 minutes.”

● **CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE**

TCP port scanner, spews SYN packets asynchronously, scanning entire Internet in under 5 minutes.

WHERE IT SITS — REALM TOP 8 BY STARS (▶ = THIS TOOL)



GitHub presence: verified — live stats · census 2026-10-17 · The Armory · realm rank #4 by adoption

05 MobSF

github.com/MobSF/Mobile-Security-Framework-MobSF

● ACTIVE 2026

★ —	—	2015	2026-10	—	—
GITHUB STARS	FORKS · REUSE	FIRST DEVELOPED	LAST PUSH	LICENSE	LANGUAGE

11	—	✓
YEARS ON GITHUB	OPEN ISSUES	2026 MOMENTUM

STAR WEIGHT VS REALM #1 (METASPLOIT FRAMEWORK · 39.2K)

REUSE SIGNAL
— fork-to-star ratio — reference-grade adoption.

ISSUE HEALTH
—.

LONGEVITY
11 years shipping code — battle-tested.

● THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

“Mobile Security Framework (MobSF) is an automated, all-in-one mobile application (Android/iOS/Windows) pen-tes”

● CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

Mobile Security Framework (MobSF) is an automated, all-in-one mobile application (Android/iOS/Windows) pen-tes

WHERE IT SITS — REALM TOP 8 BY STARS (▶ = THIS TOOL)



GitHub presence: verified — live stats · census 2026-10-17 · The Armory · realm rank #5 by adoption

06 RustScan

github.com/bee-san/RustScan

● ACTIVE 2026

★ —	—	2020	2026-10	—	—
GITHUB STARS	FORKS · REUSE	FIRST DEVELOPED	LAST PUSH	LICENSE	LANGUAGE

6	—	✓
YEARS ON GITHUB	OPEN ISSUES	2026 MOMENTUM

STAR WEIGHT VS REALM #1 (METASPLOIT FRAMEWORK · 39.2K)

REUSE SIGNAL

— fork-to-star ratio — reference-grade adoption.

ISSUE HEALTH

—.

LONGEVITY

6 years shipping code — battle-tested.

● THEIR CLAIM — AS THE PROJECT STATES IT

“🤖 The Modern Port Scanner 🤖”

● CURATOR'S NOTE — WHY IT EARNS A PLACE

🤖 The Modern Port Scanner 🤖

WHERE IT SITS — REALM TOP 8 BY STARS (▶ = THIS TOOL)



GitHub presence: verified — live stats · census 2026-10-17 · The Armory · realm rank #6 by adoption

The complete curated inventory for this realm — flagship picks marked ★. Stars and activity chips reflect the 2026-10-17 census.

Metasploit Framework ★ FLAGSHIP

★ 39.2k · since 2011 · active 2026

the world's most-used pentest framework; thousands of validated modules for exploitation, post-engagement evidence gathering and reporting in authorized tests.

github.com/rapid7/metasploit-framework

sqlmap ★ FLAGSHIP

★ 38.7k · since 2012 · GPL-2.0 · active 2026

the definitive SQL injection detection and exploitation tool for authorized web application testing.

github.com/sqlmapproject/sqlmap

Nuclei ★ FLAGSHIP

★ 32.0k · since 2020 · active 2026

template-driven vulnerability scanner; the huge community template corpus gives it detection breadth no single scanner matches.

github.com/projectdiscovery/nuclei

masscan ★ FLAGSHIP

★ 26.1k · since 2013 · AGPL-3.0 · active 2026

the fastest TCP port scanner on earth; scan the whole internet in minutes — on networks you're authorized to test.

github.com/robertdavidgraham/masscan

MobSF ★ FLAGSHIP

★ 22.0k · since 2015 · GPL-3.0

all-in-one mobile app security: static + dynamic analysis for Android/iOS in a single pipeline.

github.com/MobSF/Mobile-Security-Framework-MobSF

RustScan ★ FLAGSHIP

★ 20.6k · since 2020 · GPL-3.0

modern Rust port scanner that finds open ports in seconds and pipes them straight into Nmap.

github.com/bee-san/RustScan

Bettercap

★ 20.1k · since 2018 · GPL-3.0 · active 2026

the Swiss-army knife for authorized network assessments: ARP/DNS spoofing, MITM proxies, WiFi and BLE modules.

github.com/bettercap/bettercap

Impacket

★ 16.2k · since 2015 · active 2026

the standard Python library for low-level Windows protocol work (SMB, LDAP, Kerberos); powers wmiexec/secretsdump-class tooling and AD assessments.

github.com/fortra/impacket

OWASP ZAP

★ 15.9k · since 2015 · active 2026

the open-source intercepting proxy and scanner — a full free Burp alternative with CI/CD integration and a big add-on ecosystem.

github.com/zaproxy/zaproxy

THC-Hydra

★ 12.4k · since 2014 · AGPL-3.0 · active 2026

the classic parallelized login cracker for 50+ protocols; password audits only on systems you own or are paid to test.

github.com/vanhauser-thc/thc-hydra

Red-Teaming-Toolkit

★ 10.8k · since 2018 · curated list

curated index of adversary-emulation and red-team tradecraft resources.

github.com/infosecn1nja/Red-Teaming-Toolkit

Nikto

★ 10.8k · since 2012 · GPL-3.0; DB files have custom terms · active 2026

venerable web-server scanner; noisy but thorough on server misconfigurations and default files.

github.com/sullo/nikto

WPScan

★ 9.8k · since 2012 · free for non-commercial use · active 2026

black-box WordPress scanner: plugin/theme enumeration and version-based vuln lookups.

github.com/wpscanteam/wpscan

objection

★ 9.4k · since 2017 · GPL-3.0 · active 2026

Frida-powered runtime exploration toolkit for mobile apps — inspect and manipulate iOS/Android at runtime.

github.com/sensepost/objection

Tsunami

★ 8.6k · since 2020 · active 2026

Google's security scanner for large fleets, focused on reliably exploitable high-severity flaws with few false positives.

aircrack-ng

★ 7.7k · since 2018 · GPL-2.0 · active 2026

the complete WiFi security audit suite: capture, inject and audit — the wireless standard for two decades.

MITRE Caldera

★ 7.4k · since 2017 · active 2026

scalable adversary-emulation platform built on ATT&CK; run purple-team exercises that prove your detections actually fire.

github.com/apache/caldera

RsaCtfTool

★ 7.2k · since 2015 · GPL-3.0

RSA security-testing tool: attacks weak keys and unprotected disclosures purely offline, for auditors and CTF practice.

github.com/Ganapati/RsaCtfTool

WhatWeb

★ 6.9k · since 2010 · GPL-2.0

identifies what a website is built with — frameworks, CMSs, servers and versions — in one command.

github.com/urbanadventurer/WhatWeb

Responder

★ 6.6k · since 2016 · GPL-3.0

LLMNR/NBT-NS/MDNS poisoner; the fastest way to demonstrate credential-leak exposure on an authorized internal network.

github.com/lgandx/Responder

osmedeus

★ 6.6k · since 2018 · active 2026

workflow engine that chains recon and scanning into scheduled, repeatable attack-surface pipelines.

github.com/j3ssie/osmedeus

wafw00f

★ 6.6k · since 2014

fingerprints the web application firewall sitting in front of a site so you know exactly what you're testing against.

github.com/EnableSecurity/wafw00f

NetExec

★ 5.9k · since 2023

CrackMapExec's actively maintained successor; audit credential hygiene and service misconfigurations across whole subnets.

github.com/Pennyw0rth/NetExec

commix

★ 5.9k · since 2015 · GPL-3.0 · active 2026

automated OS command injection detection and exploitation for web tests.

github.com/commixproject/commix

Dalfox

★ 5.3k · since 2020 · active 2026

fast XSS scanner with DOM-aware analysis and a strong payload set; the modern XSS go-to.

github.com/hahwul/dalfox

OpenVAS Scanner

★ 4.9k · since 2018 · GPL-2.0 · active 2026

Greenbone's open-source vulnerability scanning engine for network and service flaws.

github.com/greenbone/openvas-scanner

tplmap

★ 4.2k · since 2016 · GPL-3.0

server-side template injection detection and exploitation across a dozen template engines; quiet upstream but still the SSTI reference.

github.com/epinna/tplmap

GitTools

★ 4.2k · since 2015

recovers an exposed `.git` directory into full source and commit history — audit your servers before attackers do.

github.com/internetwache/GitTools

Ghauri

★ 4.1k · since 2022

a strong sqlmap alternative for error/union/blind SQLi with clever parameter tampering; slower release cadence but unique value.

github.com/r0oth3x49/ghauri

BloodHound

★ 3.5k · since 2023

maps the shortest attack paths through Active Directory; defenders run it to find and fix their way to Domain Admin.

github.com/SpecterOps/BloodHound

kiterunner

★ 3.3k · since 2021 · AGPL-3.0 · active 2026

API route brute-forcer with method-aware wordlists derived from Swagger specs; dormant upstream, still the reference.

github.com/assetnote/kiterunner

ettercap

★ 2.8k · since 2012 · GPL-2.0

the veteran MITM analysis suite for ARP poisoning, sniffing and protocol dissection — bettercap's classic sibling.

github.com/Ettercap/ettercap

wapiti

★ 1.9k · since 2020 · GPL-2.0 · active 2026

open-source black-box web vulnerability scanner that crawls and audits without needing a browser.

github.com/wapiti-scanner/wapiti

JoomScan

★ 1.2k · since 2016 · GPL-3.0

OWASP's Joomla scanner: vulnerable components and misconfigurations on Joomla sites; quiet upstream, still OWASP's reference.

github.com/OWASP/joomscan

Pywerview

★ 1.1k · since 2016 · GPL-3.0 · active 2026

a Python port of PowerView's AD recon verbs; same questions, no Windows host required.

github.com/the-useless-one/pywerview

ACSTIS

★ 326 · since 2017

the classic AngularJS client-side template injection scanner — legacy framework, still found everywhere. (unmaintained classic)

github.com/tijme/angularjs-csti-scanner

jiraffe

★ 206 · since 2020 · MIT · active 2026

Jira recon and security auditing: version fingerprinting, gadget/permission checks and CVE mapping for authorized instances.

github.com/0x48piraj/jiraffe

2mny Website Vulnerability Scanner

★ 2 · since 2026

open-source web vulnerability scanner with 200 deterministic modules: OWASP Top 10, XSS/SQLi/SSRF, subdomain takeover, WordPress and AI/LLM surface checks, CVSS-scored evidence and HTML/PDF reports. Self-hosted via Docker. (maintainer's project)

github.com/RanaKhan77/Website-Vulnerability-Scanner

Nmap

the original network mapper: port, service and OS discovery plus the NSE scripting engine for everything from TLS audits to SMB checks.

nmap.org

Burp Suite Community Edition

free, proprietary

the industry-standard intercepting proxy for manual web testing; the free tier is where nearly every bug hunter starts.

portswigger.net/burp/communitydownload



End of inventory — 40 curated entries in The Armory

Census 2026-10-17 · every entry human-curated · stars and activity verified against the live GitHub API.
Thirteen more realm dossiers — Armory, Bastion, Watchtower and friends — live in the same repository.

Awesome Cyber Security Heaven

438 FREE TOOLS · 14 REALMS · ONE CURATED HEAVEN

This dossier covered **The Armory**.

Thirteen more realm dossiers wait in the same repository — Armory, Bastion, Watchtower, Cartographers, Shadow Bureau, Vault, Foundry, Sentinel Ops, Oracle's Domain, AI Forge, Free Bazaar, Academy, Proving Grounds and Workshop.

438	14	CC0
CURATED TOOLS	REALM DOSSIERS	LICENSE

github.com/RanaKhan77/awesome-cyber-security-heaven

Free forever · community-curated · 2026-10-17 census